



# Reading: Glossary terms from course 1, module 1

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## New terms and their definitions: Course 1 Module 1

**Abstraction:** To take a relatively complex system and simplify it for our use

**Algorithm:** A series of steps that solves specific problems

**ASCII:** The oldest character encoding standard used is ASCII. It represents the English alphabet, digits, and punctuation marks

**Binary system:** The communication that a computer uses is referred to as binary system, also known as base-2 numeral system

**Byte:** A group of 8 bits

**Character encoding:** Is used to assign our binary values to characters so that we as humans can read them

**Computer:** A device that stores and processes data by performing calculations

**Cryptography:** The overarching discipline that covers the practice of coding and hiding messages from third parties

**Decimal form- base 10 system:** In the decimal system, there are 10 possible numbers you can use ranging from zero to nine

**Digital divide:** The growing skills gap between people with and without digital literacy skills

**Information technology:** The use of digital technology, like computers and the internet, to store and process data into useful information

**Linux OS:** Linux is one of the largest open source operating systems used heavily in business infrastructure and in the consumer space

**Logic gates:** Allow transistors to do more complex tasks, like decide where to send electrical signals depending on logical conditions

**Open source:** This means the developers will let other developers share, modify, and distribute their software for free

**PDA (Personal Digital Assistant):** Allows computing to go mobile

**Punch cards:** A sequence of cards with holes in them to automatically perform calculations instead of manually entering them by hand

**RGB model:** RGB or red, green, and blue model is the basic model of representing colors

**UTF-8:** The most prevalent encoding standard used today

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